

docker-control — User Manual

docker-control is a Rust CLI that manages Docker-based PHP/LAMP projects. It gives you a single, opinionated interface for the whole lifecycle of a project: scaffolding it from a template, running its container stack locally, wiring up SSH agent forwarding and a shared reverse proxy, and cutting releases and deploying them to remote servers.

It runs as a **standalone binary**. Every command below can be invoked two equivalent ways:

Form	Example
Standalone binary	<code>docker-control start</code>
Shorthand alias (if configured)	<code>dc2 start</code>

This manual uses `docker-control` throughout; substitute whichever form you prefer.

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1. Installation

`docker-control` is distributed via Homebrew.

If you don't have Homebrew, install it first:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/
Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

Trust the tap. Modern Homebrew (with `HOMEbrew_REQUIRE_TAP_TRUST` set) refuses to load formulae from a non-official tap until you explicitly trust it:

```
brew trust INTERLIGENT-kommunizieren-GmbH/tap
```

Then install the tool (`brew install` taps the repository automatically):

```
brew install INTERLIGENT-kommunizieren-GmbH/tap/docker-control
```

This makes the `docker-control` command available.

Note: if `brew install` fails with a trust error, run the `brew trust` command above first. Trusted entries are stored in `~/.homebrew/trust.json` (or under `$XDG_CONFIG_HOME/homebrew/`).

Building from source

The project is Rust 2024 edition. To build and test locally:

```
cargo build --release          # release binary in target/release/
    docker-control
cargo nextest run              # run the test suite (use nextest, not
    `cargo test`)
```

Installing dependencies

`docker-control` shells out to a number of external tools (see [Dependencies](#)). To install every Homebrew-installable dependency in one step — including optional ones:

```
docker-control install-deps
```

On startup, the tool also checks for missing dependencies and, on macOS / native Linux with Homebrew, offers to install the ones it can. Beyond that, individual commands install what they specifically need on demand — e.g. `deploy` will offer to install 7-Zip, and start the ACL tools — so you rarely need to run `install-deps` by hand. See [Dependencies](#).

2. Core concepts

Managed project. Most commands require the current directory to be a *managed project*, marked by a `.managed-by-docker-control` sentinel file. `docker-control init` creates this file. Commands that mutate a project (`start`, `stop`, `build`, `console`, `setacl`, `update`, ...) refuse to run outside a managed directory.

Two repositories. A project directory is the **infrastructure / operations** layer (the compose stack, config, secrets). The actual PHP **application lives in `htdocs/`, which is a separate git repository** mounted into the php container at `/var/www/html`. Release, merge, and deploy operate on the `htdocs/` repo (and optionally vendor modules under `htdocs/vendor/<name>/`).

Template-driven. New projects are scaffolded from an embedded template. The template is compiled into the binary and extracted to your OS config directory on first run (and whenever the version changes). `docker-control update` re-syncs an existing project with the current template.

Ingress. An optional shared reverse-proxy stack that routes `https://dev` URLs to your project containers. It is a separate compose stack from your project.

3. Quick start

```
# 1. Create and enter a project directory
mkdir my-app && cd my-app

# 2. Scaffold the project (interactive: name, PHP version,
    optional git clone)
docker-control init

# 3. (Optional, once per machine) start the shared reverse proxy
docker-control start-ingress

# 4. Start the container stack
docker-control start

# 5. Trust the ingress CA (once per host) – only works after a
    project has been
#   started, since the CA is generated when the first domain is
    signed
docker-control trust-ca

# 6. Open a shell in the PHP container to run composer, bin/
    console, etc.
docker-control console

# 6. Check status at any time
docker-control status
```

Your app is then reachable at `https://<name>.lvh.me/` (the `lvh.me` domain resolves to `127.0.0.1`). `phpMyAdmin` is at `/_phpmyadmin/` and `Mailpit` at `/_mail/`.

4. Global options

These flags apply to (nearly) every command:

Flag	Description
<code>-d, --dir <DIRECTORY></code>	Operate on the given project directory instead of the current one.
<code>--debug</code>	Enable verbose debug output.
<code>-h, --help</code>	Show help. At the top level (<code>docker-control --help, -h, or</code>

Flag	Description
	help) it prints a full project status summary and lists any custom commands. After a command (docker-control <command> --help) it prints that command's own help page — its arguments, options, and description.
-V, --version	Print the docker-control version.

SSH-agent daemon control flags (handled before normal command parsing):

Flag	Description
--start-ssh-agent	Start the SSH agent forwarding daemon.
--stop-ssh-agent	Stop the SSH agent forwarding daemon.
--restart-ssh-agent	Restart the SSH agent forwarding daemon.

See [SSH agent forwarding](#) — normally you don't need these because the daemon is started automatically.

Running docker-control with **no command** prints the project status and a hint to run --help.

5. Command reference

Project lifecycle

init

Initialize the current (or --dir) directory as a managed project from the template.

Interactively prompts for: - **Project name** (defaults to the directory name; sanitized to lowercase with separators replaced by _). - **PHP version** — one of 7.4, 7.4-oci, 8.2, 8.2-oci, 8.5, 8.5-oci. - Optionally **clone a git repository into htdocs/** (SSH URL recommended).

It copies the template, renames `.gitignore-dist` → `.gitignore`, creates the `htdocs/` directory, applies host ACLs, auto-selects a free database host port in the range 33060–33099, and writes a `.env` file. If the directory is non-empty (and not already managed) it warns and asks for confirmation before overwriting.

```
docker-control init
```

start

Start the project containers in detached mode (`docker compose up -d`). Before starting, it does a throttled check (at most weekly) for outdated container images and offers to pull them. After starting, it re-applies host and container ACLs on `htdocs`.

On Linux this requires the ACL tools (`setfacl/getfacl`, from the `acl` formula); if they're missing, `start` offers to install them and aborts if they can't be obtained. macOS falls back to `chmod +a` and needs no extra tools. See [Dependencies](#).

```
docker-control start
```

stop

Stop the project containers (`docker compose down`).

```
docker-control stop
```

restart

Stop then start the containers. Also runs the outdated-image check and re-applies ACLs. Like `start`, it requires the ACL tools on Linux.

```
docker-control restart
```

status

Show a detailed project status report — plugin management, git repository state (branch + uncommitted changes), deployment config and configured environments, and Docker container status — followed by `docker compose ps`.

```
docker-control status
```

build [args...]

Build the project containers. Any extra arguments are passed straight through to `docker compose build`.

```
docker-control build
docker-control build --no-cache
```

pull

Pull the latest images for the project (`docker compose pull`).

```
docker-control pull
```

Working inside the stack

console [container]

Open an interactive bash shell inside a container. Defaults to the php container, entered as the `www-data` user with the working directory at `/var/www/html`. Pass a service name to target a different container; pass `help` to list available services.

```
docker-control console      # php container as www-data
docker-control console db    # db container
docker-control console help  # list services
```

Run `composer`, `php`, `bin/console`, `artisan`, etc. **inside** the php container via `console`, since the application is mounted there. MariaDB is also reachable from the host at `127.0.0.1:${DB_HOST_PORT}`.

setacl

Re-apply host and container ACL permissions on `htdocs` without restarting. Use this when host/container file permissions drift out of sync. The project containers must be running. On Linux it requires the ACL tools (`setfacl/getfacl`) and offers to install them if they're missing.

```
docker-control setacl
```

doctor [--fix]

Diagnose file-access problems for the project, and optionally repair them. The project containers must be running. It runs two checks:

- **Host ACL on htdocs** — whether the host user's rwX ACL (with inheritance) is actually applied, so you can edit files the container creates without `sudo`.
- **Container access to /var/www** — lists every path the container's `www-data` user cannot read or write. This surfaces the common case where Composer's home/XDG directories (`/var/www/.composer`, `.config`, `.cache`) were created later and slipped past the ACL, leaving Composer unable to write its home.

Without `--fix`, `doctor` only reports and exits non-zero if it finds problems (useful in scripts). With `--fix` it repairs both sides: it creates the Composer/XDG home directories (`.composer`, `.config`, `.cache`, `.local`), re-applies the container ACL (which also recomputes the ACL mask), and replays the host ACL on `htdocs`. Before touching the container ACL it verifies `setfacl` exists in the `php` image and, if the `acl` package is missing, tells you to update the image (`docker-control pull`) rather than failing with a cryptic error. `--fix` may prompt for `sudo` when re-applying the host ACL.

```
docker-control doctor          # report only
docker-control doctor --fix    # repair, then re-check
```

Ingress (reverse proxy)

The ingress is a shared reverse-proxy compose stack that serves your projects over HTTPS. You typically start it once per machine.

Command	Effect
<code>start-ingress</code>	Start the ingress containers (detached). Also syncs ingress volumes.
<code>stop-ingress</code>	Stop the ingress containers.
<code>restart-ingress</code>	Stop then start the ingress containers.
<code>status-ingress</code>	Show ingress container status.
<code>pull-ingress</code>	Pull the latest ingress images.
<code>trust-ca</code>	

Command	Effect
	Trust the ingress CA certificate on this host.

trust-ca

Installs the ingress proxy's self-signed CA certificate into the host trust store so your project's `https://dev` URLs are trusted without browser warnings. It handles:

- **macOS** — the System keychain (via `sudo security add-trusted-cert`).
- **Linux / WSL** — the system anchor store (Debian/Ubuntu or RHEL layout).
- **Windows** — the Windows certificate store.
- **Browsers** — the NSS trust store used by Chrome/Chromium and Firefox (via `certutil`, from the Homebrew `nss` formula) on macOS/Linux. `certutil` is only needed when a browser profile actually exists on the machine; when one does, it is **required** — `trust-ca` offers to install `nss` and errors out if it can't, rather than silently skipping the browser import. With no browser present, this step is quietly skipped.

The CA does not exist until the first domain is signed. The self-sign companion only generates the CA when it signs a project's first domain, so `start-ingress` alone is not enough — you must start at least one project first. If no CA is found, `trust-ca` tells you to start the ingress/a project first. Once a project is up, run `trust-ca` once per host. It may prompt for `sudo/admin` rights. Restart your browser afterward.

```
docker-control start-ingress # start the shared proxy
docker-control start        # start a project (signs the first
                             domain → CA is created)
docker-control trust-ca     # trust the now-existing CA
```

Release & deployment

add-deploy-config

Interactively add a deployment environment to `.deploy.json` (creating the file if needed). Prompts for environment name, SSH user, domain, server root, console command, description, optional Microsoft Teams webhook, optional COPS integration, and shared directories/files. See [Configuration files](#).

```
docker-control add-deploy-config
```

Work in progress. The release and deploy commands are still under active development and their behavior may change. When migrating a project, **Capistrano is currently used** for deployment rather than `docker-control deploy`.

release [module]

Create a new release with automatic semantic versioning. Optionally target a vendor module (otherwise you're prompted to choose the main project or a vendor module when modules exist). See [Release & merge workflows in depth](#).

```
docker-control release
docker-control release some-vendor-module
```

merge [module]

Cherry-pick a release branch back into the primary branch via an isolated `<release>-merge` branch, skipping `release:-`prefixed commits, then push for a PR. See [Release & merge workflows in depth](#).

```
docker-control merge
```

deploy <env> [options]

Deploy a selected release/tag to a configured environment. See [Deployment in depth](#).

`deploy` compresses the release with 7z, so 7-Zip is **required**: if it's missing, `deploy` offers to install it (Homebrew `p7zip`) and aborts up front if it can't, rather than failing partway through. See [Dependencies](#).

Option	Description
<env>	Target environment name (must exist in <code>.deploy.json</code>). Required.
-r, --release <REL>	Deploy a specific release/tag, skipping interactive selection.
--maintenance-mode <hard\ soft>	Maintenance mode to use with --yes (default hard).
-y, --yes	Skip all interactive prompts (non-interactive deploy).

```
docker-control deploy production
docker-control deploy staging --release 2.4.1
docker-control deploy production --yes --maintenance-mode soft
```

Custom commands

create-control-script <name>

Scaffold a new custom control script. Prompts for a description, whether the script should override a built-in command of the same name, and where to store it (inside `htdocs` or in the project root). See [Custom control scripts](#).

```
docker-control create-control-script my-command
```

<script-name> [args...]

Any shell script under `control-scripts/` or `htdocs/.docker-control/control-scripts/` is dispatched as a subcommand. Custom commands appear in the top-level `--help` with their descriptions, and `docker-control <script-name> --help` shows the script's own help via its `_help_` hook (see [Custom control scripts](#)).

```
docker-control my-command arg1 arg2
docker-control my-command --help    # runs the script's _help_
                                     hook
```

Maintenance & housekeeping

show-running

List all running projects managed by docker-control across the machine (project name and directory), discovered via Docker container labels.

```
docker-control show-running
```

update [--yes]

Re-sync **this project** with the current template. It stops the project (if running), creates a timestamped backup_<epoch>/ of the current project files, copies the template over the project (excluding logs/ and volumes/), merges .gitignore-dist into .gitignore, and restarts the project if it had been running.

This **rewrites project files**, so it asks for confirmation. In a non-interactive context it refuses unless --yes is given.

| update updates the *project*. To upgrade the *tool itself*, use upgrade.

```
docker-control update
docker-control update --yes # non-interactive
```

cleanup-backups [options]

Remove old backup_* folders left behind by update/migrate (and clean up their PhpStorm exclude entries).

Option	Description
-k, --keep <N>	Keep the N most recent backups (default 5). Deletes the rest.
--older-than <DAYS>	Delete backups older than DAYS days. Mutually exclusive with --keep.
--all	Remove all backup folders. Mutually exclusive with --keep and --older-than.
--dry-run	List what would be deleted without deleting.
-y, --yes	Skip the confirmation prompt.

```
docker-control cleanup-backups --dry-run
docker-control cleanup-backups --keep 3
docker-control cleanup-backups --older-than 30 --yes
docker-control cleanup-backups --all          # remove every
        backup (prompts first)
```

Backups are deleted as the host user, without sudo. If a backup_* folder contains files owned by root (for example vendor/ contents created inside the container), removal of that folder fails with a Permission denied warning and the command moves on to the next one — it never escalates privileges. When that happens, keep the host ACL on htdocs applied (see [doctor](#) / setacl) so container-created files stay host-owned, or remove the leftover folder manually.

Self-management

install-deps

Install every Homebrew-installable dependency (critical and optional) in one `brew install`. This command intentionally skips the normal dependency check so it can be run to fix missing dependencies. Requires Homebrew.

```
docker-control install-deps
```

install-claude

Install [Claude Code](#) and its codebase-memory-mcp companion using their official install scripts, then enable codebase-memory-mcp's auto-indexing of new projects. Each step runs its official installer directly (a `curl ... | bash` one-liner, no extra confirmation) and streams the installer's own output. Requires `curl` and `bash`.

```
docker-control install-claude
```

upgrade

Upgrade `docker-control` itself via Homebrew (`brew upgrade .../docker-control`). The tool also performs a throttled (weekly) background check and, in an interactive terminal, may offer to upgrade when a newer version is available.

```
docker-control upgrade
```

user-manual

Open this manual (the bundled `USER-MANUAL.pdf`) in your default PDF application. The PDF ships with the Homebrew distribution; a copy is also embedded in the binary as a fallback. On **WSL** it opens the manual with the **Windows** default PDF viewer (via `wslpath + cmd.exe/explorer.exe`); on macOS it uses `open`, on other Linux `xdg-open`, and on Windows `start`. This command needs no external tools (not even Docker).

```
docker-control user-manual
```

6. Project layout

A scaffolded project looks like this:

Path	Purpose
<code>compose.yml</code>	The service stack definition. Template-owned.
<code>htdocs/</code>	The application — a separate git repo (gitignored here). Mounted at <code>/var/www/html</code> .
<code>htdocs/.docker-control/</code>	Per-project config: <code>.deploy.json</code> , <code>control-scripts/</code> , <code>deployment-scripts/<env>.rhai</code> .
<code>config/</code>	Container config: <code>apache-sites/</code> , <code>php.ini</code> , <code>mariadb.cnf</code> , <code>composer.config.json</code> , <code>crontab</code> , <code>htpasswd</code> , <code>ssmtp.conf</code> .
<code>secrets/</code>	DB credential files: <code>db_name.txt</code> , <code>db_user.txt</code> , <code>db_pw.txt</code> , <code>db_root_pw.txt</code> .
<code>volumes/</code>	Persistent data: <code>db/</code> , <code>valkey/</code> , <code>composer-cache/</code> , <code>db-share/</code> .
<code>logs/</code>	Container logs: <code>apache/</code> , <code>mariadb/</code> .
<code>releases/</code>	Git worktrees used during release/merge.
<code>deployments/</code>	Deployment archives and optional Rhai hook scripts.
<code>control-scripts/</code>	

Path	Purpose
	Project-local custom subcommands.
<code>.env</code>	Project settings (see below).
<code>.managed-by-docker-control</code>	Sentinel marking the directory as managed.

7. Configuration files

`.env`

Written by `init` and read at runtime (and by `compose.yml`).

Key	Meaning
<code>PROJECTNAME</code>	Project name; the compose project name and container label.
<code>BASE_DOMAIN</code>	Dev domain, e.g. <code>myapp.lvh.me</code> (resolves to <code>127.0.0.1</code>).
<code>ENVIRONMENT</code>	App environment, e.g. <code>development</code> (maps to <code>APP_ENV</code>).
<code>DB_HOST_PORT</code>	Host port mapped to MariaDB 3306 (auto-selected at <code>init</code>).
<code>PHP_VERSION</code>	Tag for the <code>fduarte42/docker-php:<PHP_VERSION></code> image.
<code>XDEBUG_IP</code>	Host IP Xdebug connects back to (default <code>host.docker.internal</code>).
<code>IDE_KEY</code>	Xdebug IDE key.

Optional overrides consumed by `compose.yml` include `PHP_GC_MAX_LIFETIME`, `PHP_UPLOAD_LIMIT`, and `PHP_ERROR_REPORTING`.

`.deploy.json`

Deployment configuration. Search order:

1. `htdocs/.docker-control/.deploy.json` (preferred)

2. .deploy.json (project root, fallback)

The version field must be "1.0". Example:

```
{
  "version": "1.0",
  "environments": {
    "production": {
      "user": "deploy",
      "domain": "production.example.com",
      "serviceRoot": "/var/www/html",
      "console_command": "bin/console",
      "description": "Production environment - stable releases only",
      "tags": ["production", "critical"],
      "teamsWebhookUrl": "https://outlook.office.com/webhook/...",
      "copsIntegration": false,
      "sharedDirectories": ["var/log", "public/uploads"],
      "sharedFiles": [".env.local"]
    },
    "staging": {
      "user": "deploy",
      "domain": "staging.projects.interlagent.com",
      "serviceRoot": "/var/www/html",
      "description": "Staging environment for testing"
    }
  },
  "environmentOrder": ["production", "staging"],
  "defaults": {
    "serviceRoot": "/var/www/html",
    "domainSuffix": ".projects.interlagent.com"
  }
}
```

Per-environment fields:

Field	Required	Meaning
user	yes	SSH user on the target server.
domain	yes	Target server hostname.
serviceRoot	no	Deploy root on the server (default /var/www/html).

Field	Required	Meaning
console_command	no	Console entry point (default bin/console).
description	no	Human-readable description.
tags	no	Free-form labels.
branch	no	Associated branch (informational).
teamsWebhookUrl	no	Microsoft Teams webhook for deploy notifications.
copsIntegration	no	Run COPS cops:outdated / cops:permissions during deploy.
sharedDirectories	no	Directories symlinked from <serviceRoot>/ shared/ into each release.
sharedFiles	no	Files symlinked from <serviceRoot>/ shared/ into each release.

The easiest way to create/extend this file is `docker-control add-deploy-config`.

8. The container stack

`compose.yml` defines the following services:

Service	Image	Role
php	fduarte42/docker-php:\${PHP_VERSION}-debug	Apache + mod_php serving htdocs/ at / var/www/html.
db	mariadb:11.8	Database; host port \$ {DB_HOST_PORT} → 3306.

Service	Image	Role
phpmyadmin	phpmyadmin	DB admin UI at / _phpmyadmin/.
mail	axllent/mailpit	Catch-all mail UI at / _mail/.
gotenberg	gotenberg/ gotenberg:8-chromium	PDF/document conversion service.
redis	valkey/valkey:8.1	Redis-compatible cache/store.
logrotate	ghcr.io/fduarte42/ logrotate	Rotates container logs.

Networking: the frontend-tier is the external proxy network (the ingress); the backend-tier is an internal bridge. DB credentials are provided via Docker secrets sourced from secrets/*.txt.

Prefer docker-control commands over raw docker / docker compose, because the CLI also wires up SSH agent forwarding, ACL fixes, ingress, secrets, and env handling.

9. SSH agent forwarding

Deploy and release run `composer install` inside Docker containers that need access to your SSH keys (e.g. to fetch private Composer packages). To make the host SSH agent available to containers, `docker-control` runs a small **forwarding daemon** that exposes the agent on TCP port 2222 (SSH_AGENT_PORT).

- The daemon is **started automatically** when missing (unless `DOCKER_CONTROL_SKIP_SSH_AGENT` is set, or the command doesn't need SSH). Once running, the tool publishes `SSH_AUTH_PORT=<bind_ip>:2222` for `compose` and `deploy` commands.
- The bind IP is platform-dependent (127.0.0.1 on macOS/WSL/ Docker Desktop; the `docker0` bridge IP on native Linux).
- The daemon PID/logs live at `/tmp/docker-control-ssh-agent.{pid,log,err}`.

Manual control:

```
docker-control --start-ssh-agent
docker-control --stop-ssh-agent
docker-control --restart-ssh-agent
```

If you see “SSH agent forwarding is not available”, ensure ssh-agent is running and SSH_AUTH_SOCK is set in your shell.

10. Deployment in depth

Work in progress. deploy is under active development and may change. When migrating a project, **Capistrano is currently used** for deployment instead.

docker-control deploy <env> runs, in order:

1. **Load config** for <env> from .deploy.json.
2. **Select a release** — fetches tags and prompts (or uses --release).
3. **Confirm** the deployment (skipped with --yes).
4. **Teams “started” notification** (if teamsWebhookUrl is configured).
5. **Build the archive** locally: check out the release tree with git, run `composer install -o` inside a `fduarte42/docker-php:<PHP_VERSION>` container (using SSH agent forwarding), then compress with 7z into `deployments/<timestamp>_<release>.7z`.
6. **Transfer & extract** the archive to `<serviceRoot>/releases/<timestamp>_<release>/` over scp/ssh, then remove the archive.
7. **Prune** old releases, keeping the 5 most recent (never the live current).
8. **Shared paths** — symlink each `sharedDirectories/sharedFiles` entry from `<serviceRoot>/shared/` into the new release.
9. **Reload FPM** (`sudo php-fpm-reload.sh`).
10. **Maintenance mode** — enable hard or soft on the current and new releases.
11. **Hooks: pre_deploy** (Rhai; see below).
12. **Deployment tasks** — clear opcode, clear ORM metadata/query caches; optionally clear result cache, run `migrations:migrate`, and run `orm:schema-tool:update` (each prompted unless --yes).
13. **COPS integration** (if enabled) — `cops:outdated` and `cops:permissions`, with prompts to continue on failure.
14. **Hooks: post_deploy**.
15. **Manual pause** — in interactive mode, waits for ENTER so you can run ad-hoc commands on the server before going live.
16. **Flip the current symlink** to the new release.
17. **Disable maintenance mode** and do a final opcode clear.

18. **Hooks:** `done_deploy`.

19. **Teams “success”/“failed” notification.**

On failure the local archive is removed and (if configured) a “failed” Teams notification is sent; maintenance mode is best-effort restored.

Deployment hooks (Rhai)

You can inject custom SSH steps at three points: `pre_deploy`, `post_deploy`, and `done_deploy`. Hooks are Rhai scripts loaded from the first of:

1. `htdocs/.docker-control/deployment-scripts/<env>.rhai`
2. `deployments/scripts/<env>.rhai`

Each hook is an optional function receiving (`console_current`, `release_dir`, `console_new`, `server_root`) and can call `exec_ssh(command)` to run commands on the target server:

```
fn pre_deploy(console_current, release_dir, console_new,
server_root) {
    exec_ssh(console_new + " app:warmup");
}
```

```
fn post_deploy(console_current, release_dir, console_new,
server_root) {
    exec_ssh("echo Deployed " + release_dir);
}
```

Functions you don’t define are simply skipped.

11. Release & merge workflows in depth

Work in progress. The release workflow is still under active development and may change.

Both workflows operate on the `htdocs/` repository (or a vendor module under `htdocs/vendor/<name>/`) using isolated git **worktrees** under `releases/` so your working tree is never disturbed.

release

1. Optionally select the main project or a vendor module.

2. Pre-flight: `fetch`, determine the primary branch, update it.
3. Determine the version:
 - No release branches yet → initial release **1.0.x**.
 - **Breaking change?** → next major `X.0.x`.
 - **New feature?** → next minor `X.Y.x`.
 - Otherwise → **patch**: pick an existing `X.Y.x` branch, next patch `X.Y.Z`.
4. **Minor/major/initial** create a new `X.Y.x` **branch**: update `composer.json` version to `X.Y.x-dev`, generate `composer.lock` via Docker, commit both, generate a `CHANGELOG.md`, and push the branch.
5. **Patch** creates a **tag** on the `X.Y.x` branch: update `composer.json` to the exact version, generate the changelog, create tag `X.Y.Z`, and push the tag.

`release:`-prefixed commits are used for the `composer.json/lock` bookkeeping so they can be excluded when merging back.

merge

1. Optionally select the main project or a vendor module.
2. Pre-flight: `fetch`, determine primary branch, list release branches, pick one.
3. Create two worktrees: the release branch, and a new `<release>-merge` branch based on `origin/<primary>`.
4. Compute the commits on the release branch not in primary, **excluding release: commits**, and confirm.
5. Cherry-pick each commit. On conflict, choose to **launch the merge tool**, mark it **resolved**, or **abort**.
6. On success, push `<release>-merge` and print next steps for opening a PR from `<release>-merge` into the primary branch. The local merge branch is cleaned up on a successful push; on failure or if you decline the push, it's preserved for inspection.

12. Custom control scripts

Custom commands are plain bash scripts discovered from (in priority order):

1. `htdocs/.docker-control/control-scripts/`
2. `control-scripts/`

Create one with `docker-control create-control-script <name>`. It's run with the project directory as the working directory and `PROJECT_DIR` set in its environment.

A script supports three special probe arguments:

- `_desc_` — print a one-line description (shown in the top-level `--help` list).
- `_help_` — print a detailed help page (shown by `docker-control <name> --help`). If a script doesn't implement `_help_`, `--help` falls back to its `_desc_` description. The probe only runs on scripts that contain a quoted `_help_`, so older scripts are never executed just to render help.
- `_override_` — print true to always win a name clash with a built-in command.

Generated skeleton:

```
#!/bin/bash
set -e

if [[ "$1" == "_desc_" ]]; then
    # short description (shown in the command list)
    echo "My command description"
    exit 0
fi

if [[ "$1" == "_help_" ]]; then
    # detailed help (shown by `docker-control my-command --help`)
    echo "my-command - My command description"
    echo
    echo "Usage: docker control my-command [arguments]"
    exit 0
fi

# Optional: always override a same-named built-in command
if [[ "$1" == "_override_" ]]; then
    echo "true"
    exit 0
fi

echo "my-command - WAITING FOR IMPLEMENTATION"
exit 0
```

Name clashes

If a custom script has the same name as a built-in command (e.g. `build.sh`), you'll be prompted to choose which runs. Pressing Enter/Escape keeps the built-in. Add the `_override_` block to make your script always win without a prompt. When a custom script wins a clash with a built-in that requires a managed project, the managed-project check is still enforced.

13. Environment variables

Variable	Effect
DOCKER_CONTROL_SKIP_DEPENDENCY_CHECK	Skip external tool dependency checks.
DOCKER_CONTROL_SKIP_SSH_AGENT	Skip SSH agent management.
DOCKER_CONTROL_SKIP_IMAGE_CHECK	Skip the outdated-image check on start/restart.
DOCKER_CONTROL_SKIP_SELF_UPDATE_CHECK	Skip the weekly self-update check.
DOCKER_CONTROL_INGRESS_DIR	Override the ingress directory location.
DOCKER_CONTROL_TEMPLATE_DIR	Override the template directory location.
HOMEbrew_PREFIX	Override the detected Homebrew prefix (used for ingress paths).
SSH_AUTH_PORT	Set automatically to <code><bind_ip>:2222</code> ; read by <code>deploy/release</code> Docker commands.
SSH_AUTH_SOCK	Standard SSH agent socket; required for agent forwarding.
PHP_VERSION	Read from the project <code>.env</code> ; used for the <code>fduarte42/docker-php</code> image tag.

14. Dependencies

External tools `docker-control` relies on. Critical tools must be present or every command aborts at startup. The tools marked “on demand” below are not required in general, but are **mandatory for the specific command that uses them**: when you run such a command and its tool is missing, `docker-control` offers to install it there and then aborts if it can’t, instead of failing later with a cryptic error. The remaining optional tools simply enable extra features.

Tool	Required	Used for
Docker ($\geq$ 20.10)	yes	All container operations.
Docker Compose ($\geq$ 2.4)	yes	Managing the service stack.
Git	yes	Release and merge workflows.
SSH	yes	Remote access during deploy.
SCP	yes	File transfers during deploy.
Bash	yes	Executing custom scripts.
Sudo	no	Elevated privileges (migration, <code>trust-ca</code>).
Rsync	no	Migration tasks.
7-Zip (7z, p7zip formula)	on demand	Building deployment packages — required by deploy.
setfacl / getfacl (acl formula)	on demand (Linux)	Host/container ACLs — required by <code>start/restart/setacl</code> on Linux (macOS falls back to <code>chmod</code>).
certutil (nss formula)	on demand	Browser CA trust for <code>trust-ca</code> — required when a browser NSS store exists.

Installing dependencies. Missing tools that have a Homebrew formula can be installed interactively when a command needs one, or all at once with `install-deps`. Because `docker-control` is distributed via Homebrew, **Homebrew itself is treated as non-optional**: if a tool needs installing but `brew` is not found, that's a hard error pointing you at <https://brew.sh> rather than a silent skip.

Docker/Docker Compose/SSH/SCP are not installed by `install-deps` (Docker needs a daemon; Homebrew's `openssh` is keg-only), so install those yourself.

15. Troubleshooting

“... not managed by docker control plugin”. The directory lacks `.managed-by-docker-control`. Run `docker-control init`, or use `--dir` to point at the right project.

“No deployment configuration found (.deploy.json)”. Run `docker-control add-deploy-config` to create one.

“No tags found in repository” on deploy. Cut a release first with `docker-control release`.

Composer can't reach private repos during release/deploy. The SSH agent forwarding daemon may not be running. Check that `ssh-agent` is up and `SSH_AUTH_SOCK` is set, then `docker-control --restart-ssh-agent`.

trust-ca reports no CA certificate found. The CA is only generated when the self-sign companion signs the first domain. Start the ingress **and** at least one project (`docker-control start-ingress` then `docker-control start`) before running `trust-ca`.

Browser still warns about the dev HTTPS cert. Ensure the ingress and a project are running so the CA exists, run `docker-control trust-ca`, then restart the browser. On Linux, `certutil` (Homebrew `nss`) is needed for browser trust.

setacl says containers aren't running. Start the project first with `docker-control start`.

Composer can't write its home (/var/www/.composer or .config). The container ACL missed directories created after startup. Run `docker-control doctor` to see the offending paths, then `docker-control doctor`

--fix to create the Composer/XDG homes and re-apply the ACLs. If doctor --fix reports setfacl is missing from the php image, refresh it with docker-control pull.

update refuses to run. In a non-interactive shell it won't rewrite a project without --yes. Remember update rewrites the *project* from the template (a backup is created); to upgrade the *tool*, use upgrade.

Too many backup_* folders after updates. Clean them with docker-control cleanup-backups (--dry-run first to preview).

Docker image version warnings on start. docker-control checks image freshness weekly and offers to pull. Set DOCKER_CONTROL_SKIP_IMAGE_CHECK=1 to disable.

This manual documents docker-control and is kept alongside the source. For a concise command list, run docker-control --help.